FairHaul – Food Delivery App PRD

TL;DR

FairHaul is a disruptive food delivery platform prioritizing drivers by offering full pay transparency, direct pay negotiation, and dynamic surge rates—ending hidden costs and restoring driver agency. The app earns revenue from restaurant listing fees and premium placement options. Customers benefit from a seamless checkout with zero added taxes or fees, and restaurants get direct relationships with drivers and flexible cost control.

Goals

Business Goals

- Grow active restaurant listings by 20% month-over-month via a subscription/listing fee and premium placement model.
- Achieve and maintain a driver retention rate above 85% monthly through transparent, competitive pay experiences.
- Drive 40% of restaurant partners to purchase at least one premium placement per quarter.
- Minimize customer checkout abandonment rates below 10% by promoting a clean, no-surprise UI.
- Establish FairHaul's brand as the top choice for driver fairness within six months of launch.

User Goals

- Drivers gain complete pay transparency on every job, with no hidden fees or withheld details.
- Drivers can negotiate pay on each delivery, giving them real leverage especially during peak demand.
- Restaurants can directly configure pay rates, offer surge incentives, and boost listings on the platform.
- Customers enjoy straightforward ordering with no taxes or surprise charges at checkout.
- All users benefit from a trusted, transparent, and efficient platform.

Non-Goals

- FairHaul does **not** process driver payments; restaurants pay drivers directly, outside the app.
- The platform does **not** set or enforce driver pay rates—negotiation is between driver and restaurant.
- FairHaul does **not** own or employ a delivery fleet; all drivers are independent.

User Stories

Driver (Primary Persona)

- As a **Driver**, I want to see exactly what the restaurant will pay me before accepting a delivery, so that I can make informed decisions.
- As a **Driver**, I want to negotiate my pay rate with the restaurant in-app, so that I can maximize my earnings for each job.
- As a **Driver**, I want to receive alerts when restaurants offer higher pay during peak hours, so that I can prioritize the most lucrative jobs.
- As a **Driver**, I want to view my completed deliveries and earnings history, so that I can track my performance and income reliably.

Restaurant Owner (Secondary Persona)

- As a **Restaurant Owner**, I want to post and manage listings on the platform, so that my business reaches new local customers.
- As a **Restaurant Owner**, I want to set the base pay for drivers and offer increased rates during busy periods, so that I attract delivery partners quickly.
- As a **Restaurant Owner**, I want to purchase premium placement to boost my restaurant's visibility, so that I receive more orders during competitive times.
- As a **Restaurant Owner**, I want to review feedback and ratings from drivers, so that I can improve my offers and relationships.

Customer (Tertiary Persona)

- As a **Customer**, I want to browse available restaurants and menus easily, so that I can quickly find something to order.
- As a **Customer**, I want a simple checkout process with no surprise taxes or fees, so that I know exactly what I'm paying.
- As a **Customer**, I want real-time order tracking, so that I can anticipate delivery arrival.
- As a **Customer**, I want to rate my delivery and experience, so that I can provide feedback for continuous improvement.

Functional Requirements

Driver Features (Priority: P0)

- **Pay Transparency Dashboard:** Show full pay (as set by restaurant) for each job before driver accepts or negotiates.
- **In-App Rate Negotiation:** Enable drivers to counter proposed pay; restaurant can accept, counter, or decline.
- **Peak-Hour Dynamic Pay Alerts:** Notify drivers when restaurants increase pay during periods of high demand.
- **Earnings History:** Allow drivers to see completed jobs, negotiated rates, and total earnings.

Restaurant Features (Priority: P0)

- **Listing Management:** Create, modify, and remove restaurant listings; manage menu and operational details.
- **Driver Pay Rate Configuration:** Set and update offered pay rates per delivery, including minimums and custom rates.
- **Peak-Hour Surge Controls:** Instantly boost pay offers during preset hours or on-demand.

- **Premium Placement Purchase:** Buy premium ad slots for increased restaurant visibility.

Customer Features (Priority: P0)

- **Browse/Search Restaurants:** Discover available restaurants by category, cuisine, or proximity.
- **Cart & Clean Checkout:** Intuitive cart system; no tax line or hidden fees at checkout.
- **Real-Time Order Tracking:** Follow order progress from kitchen prep to driver delivery.
- **Add Ratings/Feedback:** Rate delivery and restaurant post-order.

Platform Features (Priority: P1)

- **Listing Fee Billing:** Manage recurring or pay-as-you-go listing fees for restaurants.
- **Premium Placement Engine:** Ad module to manage, track, and rotate premium listings.
- **Driver-Restaurant Rating System:** Both sides can rate each other for quality and reliability.

User Experience

Entry Point & First-Time User Experience

- **Drivers:**
  - Download FairHaul app or visit web portal.
  - Complete sign-up, including mobile/email verification and identity/vehicle documentation (license, insurance, etc.).
  - Set availability (schedule or ad hoc).
  - Optional onboarding tutorial showing quick negotiation and pay transparency features.
- **Restaurants:**
  - Register business via web or mobile.
  - Submit verification details (business license, address).
  - Pay listing subscription or fee to activate account.
  - Set up menu and baseline driver pay, add premium placement if desired.
- **Customers:**
  - Open app (web/mobile), browse as guest or create simple account (social/email login).
  - Location auto-detected or set manually.
  - Fast onboarding: search, browse, and order without needing to provide payment info until checkout.

Core Experience

Driver Flow

1. **Job Offer Received:**
   - Real-time push notification and in-app alert shows new delivery opportunity.

    - Display: restaurant, pickup/dropoff location, distance, and full proposed pay.
    - Options: Accept, Counteroffer, or Decline.
2. **Counteroffer (Negotiation):**
    - Driver submits desired pay rate.
    - Restaurant receives proposal and can accept, counter, or decline.
    - Real-time feedback—loader/spinner with expected wait (max 45 seconds).
    - If accepted, prompt driver for confirmation; job is now assigned and details are unlocked.
    - If declined, driver automatically shown next available job or option to browse offers.
3. **Peak-Hour Dynamics:**
    - When surge is active, push notifications highlight increased rates.
    - Competing offers from multiple restaurants possible; highest bids shown first.
4. **Pickup & Delivery:**
    - Standard step-by-step workflow: navigate to restaurant, confirm pickup, deliver to customer, optionally message each party.
    - End-of-job confirmation, manual record of pay method (since payments are out-of-app).
5. **Earnings & History:**
    - View all completed jobs, pay received, and negotiation history in-app.

Restaurant Flow

1. **Listing/Onboarding:**
    - Register, verify, pay listing fee, configure menu, set standard driver pay rate.
2. **Pay Adjustment & Premiums:**
    - Adjust base pay for all jobs or use one-click surge to raise rates during busy times (e.g., dinner rush).
    - Purchase and activate premium placement directly from dashboard; see live stats.
3. **Responding to Counteroffers:**
    - Get real-time pings when drivers negotiate—respond via accept, counter, or decline.
4. **Order Fulfillment:**
    - View order queue, assigned drivers, and delivery status dashboard.
5. **Ratings & Feedback:**
    - See aggregate and individual ratings from drivers.

Customer Flow

1. **Browse & Select:**
    - Scroll or search among available restaurants, tap to view menu and ratings.
2. **Build Cart & Checkout:**
    - Add dishes, see clear prices, and go to checkout—no taxes or service fees, total up front.
    - Choose payment (card, wallet, etc.), confirm order.
3. **Track Order:**

    - Real-time updates on prep, driver assignment, journey, and ETA.
4. **Complete & Rate:**
    - Rate driver/restaurant, tip via suggested or custom amount.

Advanced Features & Edge Cases

- Driver counteroffer rejected: present next best available job, no penalty.
- Restaurant boosts pay mid-surge: all available drivers get push update, can immediately accept updated offer.
- Driver inactivity or late response: job reassigns automatically after timeout.
- Disputed delivery: both parties rate each other, escalate via help center if needed.
- Payments between driver and restaurant handled externally (e.g., cash, direct transfer, or separate system).

UI/UX Highlights

- Consistent color-coding for pay/surge states (green = premium).
- Modals and confirmation banners for negotiations, with accessibility standards (e.g., screen reader compatibility, high-contrast mode).
- Responsive design: intuitive on both mobile and desktop/tablet.
- Clean, single-screen checkout for customers.
- Real-time notifications unobtrusive but visible.

Narrative

Marcus, a dedicated full-time driver, was growing frustrated with the standard food delivery apps. Despite working long shifts, he was often blindsided by hidden deductions and had no say over his pay. Then he discovered FairHaul: a new food delivery platform where drivers see exactly how much a job pays—before accepting—no hidden surprises. One busy Friday, Marcus logs into FairHaul and sees a $14 delivery offer from his favorite local burrito spot. During the lunch rush, he counters at $16, knowing the restaurant may go higher to fill orders quickly. Moments later, his phone buzzes—the restaurant accepts. With one tap, Marcus claims the job, heads over, and delivers lunch to a hungry downtown customer.

At the same time, Sofia, a customer tired of extra “fees” at checkout, places her FairHaul order and is delighted to find that what she sees is what she pays—no tax line, no “service charge,” just her meal. The process is simple, quick, and transparent.

By the end of the shift, Marcus has tracked all his jobs and earnings in his app, while the burrito spot enjoys higher delivery completion rates and the customer leaves a glowing rating. FairHaul’s unique model empowers the driver, gives restaurants flexibility, and delights customers, all while building a more sustainable gig economy.

Success Metrics

Metric	Measurement Method

Driver Acceptance Rate	% of job offers accepted by drivers
Avg Driver Earnings/Hour	Median gross hourly pay, tracked per delivery
Customer Checkout Abandonment	% of initiated checkouts not completed
Active Restaurant Listings	Number of active, paying restaurant listings per month
Premium Placement Revenue	Total $ from premium ad slots purchased
Monthly Driver Retention Rate	% of active drivers who return the following month
Job Offer Load Time	Time from offer sent to view (< 2 seconds goal)
Negotiation Response Time	Time for restaurant to respond to counteroffer
App Uptime	% of time platform is operational (99.9%+ goal)

User-Centric Metrics

- Driver adoption and onboarding completion rates.
- % jobs with successful negotiation vs. outright acceptance.
- Driver and restaurant average ratings.
- Customer repeat order rate.

Business Metrics

- Number of new listings and premium placement purchases per month.
- Restaurant churn/retention indexes.
- Revenue per active restaurant.
- Monthly active users across all cohorts.

Technical Metrics

- Average negotiation latency per job.
- Infrastructure uptime and reliability (%).
- Response time for push notifications and surge alerts.
- API error rates and failed job assignment rates.

Tracking Plan

- Job offer sent/viewed/accepted/declined/countered.
- Counteroffer accepted/declined (per party, per job).
- Peak pay alert sent/opened/accepted.
- Premium placement ad viewed/clicked.
- Restaurant listing created/updated.
- Order placed/abandoned/completed.
- Checkout flow events (start/finish).
- Ratings and feedback submissions.

Technical Considerations

Technical Needs

- **Real-Time Job Offer Engine:** WebSocket-powered messaging system to deliver, update, and coordinate job offers and negotiations instantaneously.
- **Dynamic Pricing & Negotiation Logic:** Algorithms and UI for handling pay transparency, counters, and fast responses.
- **Push Notification System:** Device-native and fallback channel support for alerting drivers (surge, negotiation, new jobs).
- **Restaurant Dashboard:** Web/mobile interface for listing management, pay adjustment, premium placements, and feedback.
- **Driver Mobile App:** Robust, lightweight, focused primarily on job board, negotiation, and navigation.
- **Customer App:** Browsing, search, order management, checkout; optimized for speed and clarity.

Integration Points

- **Identity Verification:** Partner with reliable third-party KYC/AML services for driver onboarding.
- **Payment Processing:** Only for customer-to-restaurant transactions; NOT for restaurant-driver pay, which happens externally.
- **POS/Menu Integrations:** Optional API hooks for restaurants to sync menus or order status with existing POS systems.

Data Storage & Privacy

- **Driver Data:** Store identity, job/earnings history, rating logs. Sensitive payment data NOT stored.
- **Restaurant Listings:** Menu, location, operational hours, active pay rates.
- **Order History:** Customer orders, delivery status, ratings.
- **Privacy & Compliance:** Strict GDPR/CCPA compliance. All user info encrypted. Only store data essential for workflow and compliance.
- **No Payment Data:** Driver pay is negotiated and paid outside the platform; no bank/card details for drivers retained by FairHaul.

Scalability & Performance

- Platform must handle high concurrency, especially during predictable lunch/dinner surges.
- App latency (push, offer, negotiation) should remain <2 seconds regardless of load.

- APIs containerized for auto-scaling; notification and job engines horizontally scalable.

Potential Challenges

- **Fraud Prevention:** Robust checks for driver identity and verification. Monitor for abuse of negotiation system (e.g., fake declines for higher base pay).
- **Real-Time Negotiation Reliability:** Guarantee sub-second updates for negotiation; design fallback mechanisms for slow internet.
- **Restaurant Compliance:** Monitor, track, and enforce agreements to pay as negotiated to drivers, even though payment is external—tools for dispute resolution and review.
- **Multi-Platform Consistency:** Ensure UI and features remain consistent and bug-free across web, iOS, and Android.

Milestones & Sequencing

Project Estimate

- **Medium Project:** 3-4 weeks total, fast-launch MVP.

Team Size & Composition

- **Small, Agile Team:**
  - 1 Product Manager/UX Designer
  - 2 Full-stack Engineers
  - 1 Mobile Engineer

Suggested Phases

Phase 1: Driver-App Core & Restaurant Dashboard (Week 1–2)

- *Deliverables:*
  - Driver onboarding and document verification
  - Real-time job offers with pay transparency
  - Accept/decline/counteroffer negotiation flow
  - Restaurant registration, listing, and pay configuration dashboard
- *Dependencies:* Identity verification API

Phase 2: Peak Pay Logic, Notification Engine, Customer Checkout (Week 2–3)

- *Deliverables:*
  - Dynamic surge pricing and real-time push alerts to drivers/restaurants
  - Customer-facing web/mobile order flow and no-tax checkout UI
  - Real-time order tracking (driver status updates)
- *Dependencies:* Core driver/restaurant app; push notification service; payment processor for customer-to-restaurant

Phase 3: Premium Placement Engine, Billing, Ratings, QA & Launch (Week 3–4)

- *Deliverables:*
  - Premium placement module with self-serve ad purchases for restaurants

    - Listing fee/billing integration
    - Mutual driver/restaurant rating system
    - Full-stack QA, performance validation, app store readiness
- *Dependencies:* Restaurant dashboard from Phase 1

End of Document